

Cthulhu Eternal: An Any-Time Lovecraftian Roleplaying Game

Cheat Sheet Summary of Changes

Localization for **Stone Age Settings**
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WHAT THIS FILE IS – AND WHAT IT IS NOT

The **Cthulhu Eternal** System is a multi-era, multi-setting ruleset for tabletop roleplaying. At its core it has a streamlined set of universal d100-based rules which govern most elements of the game. While these universal rules define the core of the game, each era-specific version of the rules (which we call “localizations” of the game) have certain era-specific rules and modifications.

For each such localization, a complete ruleset (or “System Reference Document” on OGL-speak) has been compiled. Such localized SRDs reproduce all the universal material that is the core part of *Cthulhu Eternal's* game “DNA” inserting specific sections into the rules text to deal with the technology, social conventions, or other special things that make the era/setting different from others. These extra rules often describe:

- New skills lists, and sets of protagonist archetypes,
- Special options for running combat in the setting,
- Portrayals of mental illness that capture the beliefs and understanding common to the setting,
- Details of vehicles, poisons, and common diseases of the era, and
- Any other specific modifications the game designers thought would better capture the setting's flavor.

Because an SRD has both the universal rules AND local modifications, each is quite a substantial document (~ 100 pages). They are effectively self-contained rulebooks in their own right: someone could run a game using the SRD alone.

If you are new to the *Cthulhu Eternal* system, the best place to learn the rules (localized to a specific era/setting) is with one of the SRDs. However, once you've learned one localization the system and have a need to familiarize yourself with another, reading through the entire SRD for the new setting is overkill. Most of the rules are similar – what you really want to know is “what's different about this new localization?”

That's exactly what this “Cheat Sheet” is designed to provide you – just the new stuff for a localization. Coupled with your general understanding of the game, this information will get you going quickly. This document definitely is NOT a full rulebook. Also, some minor era-specific details might not get noted here: for those you should refer back to the full details in the SRD (which this document also points to in some places).

Protagonists

The table below shows the set of skills available to Protagonists in Stone Age games. The table also shows the base ratings for each skill, and which can be specialized. The descriptions of each skill may be found on page 9.

Adversity Skills: if your Protagonist gets additional skill picks for enduring an especially harsh upbringing, they can only spend those picks on Carouse, First Aid, Other Tribe, or Scavenge.

>> Skills and Base Ratings	
Alertness (20)	Insight (10)
Animal Handling (10)	Make Fire (20)
Appraise (10)	Melee Weapons (30)
Art (Type) (0)	Mysticism (Type) (10)
Athletics (30)	Navigate (10)
Augury (0)	Oral Tradition (10)
Beguile (20)	Other Tribe (0)
Boatbuilding (10)	Persuade (20)
Boating (0)	Poisons (0)
Carouse (0)	Ranged Weapons (20)
Craft (Type) (0)	Reassure (10)
Disguise/Mimic (10)	Repair/Devise (0)
Dodge (30)	Ride (10)
First Aid (10)	Scavenge (10)
Folklore (10)	Search (20)
Forage/Hunt (10)	Spirit World (10)
Foreign Tongue (Type) (0)	Stealth (10)
Harangue/Taunt (10)	Swim (20)
Healing (0)	Track (10)
Herb Lore (20)	Unarmed Combat (40)
Homeland (0)	Unnatural (0)
Inscriptions (0)	Weather & Season (20)

Archetypes

>> A Note on Written Language
The advent of writing in Stone Age settings is a miniscule slice of time. The earliest known written language dates to 3200 BCE and even then, few would know how to read and write. The limited (or non-existent) education opportunities available to most individuals means that only a relatively small percentage of people are literate. Such skills are usually limited to professions which routinely involve reading or writing documents. Being illiterate doesn't mean you can't communicate verbally – but it does make it difficult or impossible to understand any information encountered in written form. In game terms, literacy is represented by the Protagonist's rating in the Inscriptions skill (described in the skill listings). By default, this skill begins at zero, although some archetypes furnish the Protagonist with a higher starting value – these apply only when playing games set later than 3200 BCE (if playing games in earlier times, take the skill points for Inscriptions and reallocate them to any other skill of your choosing except Unnatural). You can choose to reserve some bonus skill picks to invest in boosting the Inscription skill regardless of whether it is part of the Archetype list or not (although it only makes sense in an era where writing exists). An Inscriptions skill rating of 40% or more would indicate a good level of basic proficiency with the local forms of carved or painted writing.

The following archetypes are available for Protagonists in Stone Age games.

List of Archetypes

The following Archetypes are appropriate for games of Lovecraftian investigation set in Stone Age settings. Archetypes represent the roles that Protagonists fulfill in society. An archetype could represent the life a character had before they were drawn into investigating cosmic horror. Or it could represent the role they still try to maintain to the best of their ability while the horrors slowly erode everything they thought they understood.

Each archetype has a collection of skills that represent knowledge areas the Protagonist uses in their daily lives.

This list doesn't cover every possible character type but focus on likely protagonists in mystery and investigation tales. The GM is encouraged to develop other archetypes to cover other character types suggested by players. Guidelines for developing new Archetypes may be found in the SRD.

Herbalist

RECOMMENDED STATS: INT

ARCHETYPAL SKILLS:

- First Aid 70%
- Folklore 50%
- Forage/Hunt 50%
- Healing 70%
- Herb Lore 60%
- Make Fire 60%
- Poisons 50%
- Search 50%

Choose any 2 of these that you don't already have:

- Alertness 60%
- Beguile 60%
- Inscriptions 40%
- Insight 50%
- Persuade 60%
- Reassure 50%
- Scavenge 50%
- Weather/Seasons 60%

STARTING RESOURCES: 5, if Protagonist is from an **agricultural** lifestyle; for **hunter/gatherers** the starting resources is the resources rating of the clan/tribe in which they live (or 0 if they have been cast out of their group)

BONDS: 2 [if Protagonist is from a **hunter/gatherer** lifestyle one of these will *automatically* be a Community Bond to the clan/tribe with strength CHA+2, the remaining bonds allocated using the standard process]

Hunter / Farmer / Forager

RECOMMENDED STATS: DEX, STR

ARCHETYPAL SKILLS:

- Animal Handling 50%
- Athletics 70%

- Craft (Traps, Snares, etc.) 60%
- Forage/Hunt 50%
- Ranged Weapons 60%
- Repair/Devise 40%
- Ride 40%

Choose any 3 of these that you don't already have:

- Carouse 40%
- First Aid 50%
- Herb Lore 60%
- Homeland 40%
- Melee Weapons 70%
- Navigate 50%
- Search 60%
- Track 50%
- Weather/Seasons 60%

STARTING RESOURCES: 4, if Protagonist is from an **agricultural** lifestyle; for **hunter/gatherers** the starting resources is the resources rating of the clan/tribe in which they live (or 0 if they have been cast out of their group)

BONDS: 4 [if Protagonist is from a **hunter/gatherer** lifestyle one of these will *automatically* be a Community Bond to the clan/tribe with strength CHA+2, the remaining bonds allocated using the standard process]

Leader / Elder

RECOMMENDED STATS: CHA, STR

ARCHETYPAL SKILLS:

- Carouse 40%
- Forage/Hunt 40%
- Harangue/Taunt 50%
- Homeland 60%
- Inscriptions 30%
- Insight 40%
- Make Fire 50%
- Melee Weapons 50%
- Spirit World 50%

Choose any 2 of these that you don't already have:

- Boatbuilding 50%
- Dodge 70%
- First Aid 50%
- Foreign Tongue (Type) 40%
- Oral Tradition 50%
- Other Tribe (Type) 40%
- Poisons 40%
- Ranged Weapons 60%
- Ride 50%

STARTING RESOURCES: 5, if Protagonist is from an **agricultural** lifestyle; for **hunter/gatherers** the starting resources is the resources rating of the clan/tribe in which they live (or 0 if they have been cast out of their group)

BONDS: 3 [if Protagonist is from a **hunter/gatherer** lifestyle one of these will *automatically* be a Community Bond to the clan/tribe with strength CHA+2, the remaining bonds allocated using the standard process. If Protagonist is from an agricultural lifestyle, one of their bonds will be a Community Bond with a starting score of 12]

Scout / Pathfinder

RECOMMENDED STATS: DEX, STR

ARCHETYPAL SKILLS:

- Athletics 60%
- Forage/Hunt 70%
- Make Fire 50%
- Navigate 60%
- Other Tribe (Type) 50%
- Ride 60%
- Search 50%
- Track 50%
- Weather/Seasons 60%

Choose any 3 of these that you don't already have:

- Alertness 60%
- Animal Handling 50%
- Beguile 60%
- Boatbuilding 50%
- Boating 40%
- Folklore 50%
- Foreign Tongue (Type) 40%
- Inscriptions 40%
- Repair/Devise 40%
- Scavenge 50%

STARTING RESOURCES: 4, if Protagonist is from an **agricultural** lifestyle; for **hunter/gatherers** the starting resources is the resources rating of the clan/tribe in which they live (or 0 if they have been cast out of their group)

BONDS: 2 [if Protagonist is from a **hunter/gatherer** lifestyle one of these will *automatically* be a Community Bond to the clan/tribe with strength CHA+2, the remaining bonds allocated using the standard process]

Shaman / Mystic

RECOMMENDED STATS: INT

ARCHETYPAL SKILLS:

- Augury 50%
- Insight 60%
- Mysticism (Type) 70%
- Oral Tradition 60%

- Reassure 60%
- Spirit World 70%
- Weather/Seasons 60%

Choose any 1 of these that you don't already have:

- Alertness 60%
- Beguile 60%
- Foreign Tongue (Type) 40%
- Herb Lore 60%
- Inscriptions 40%
- Make Fire 60%
- Mysticism (Type) 50%
- Other Tribe (Type) 40%
- Persuade 60%
- Poisons 40%

STARTING RESOURCES: 5, if Protagonist is from an **agricultural** lifestyle; for **hunter/gatherers** the starting resources is the resources rating of the clan/tribe in which they live (or 0 if they have been cast out of their group)

BONDS: 3 [if Protagonist is from a **hunter/gatherer** lifestyle one of these will *automatically* be a Community Bond to the clan/tribe with strength CHA+2, the remaining bonds allocated using the standard process]

Storyteller

RECOMMENDED STATS: POW, CHA

ARCHETYPAL SKILLS:

- Art (Storytelling, Acting, etc.) 70%
- Beguile 60%
- Folklore 60%
- Inscriptions 40%
- Insight 50%
- Oral Tradition 70%
- Persuade 60%
- Spirit World 50%

Choose any 3 of these that you don't already have:

- Augury 40%
- Carouse 40%
- Disguise/Mimic 50%
- Foreign Tongue (Type) 40%
- Harangue/Taunt 50%
- Homeland 40%
- Mysticism (Type) 50%
- Reassure 50%

STARTING RESOURCES: 3, if Protagonist is from an **agricultural** lifestyle; for **hunter/gatherers** the starting resources is the resources rating of the clan/tribe in which they live (or 0 if they have been cast out of their group)

BONDS: 3 [if Protagonist is from a **hunter/gatherer** lifestyle one of these will *automatically* be a Community Bond to the clan/tribe with strength CHA+2, the remaining bonds allocated using the standard process]

Thief / Outcast

RECOMMENDED STATS: DEX, CHA

ARCHETYPAL SKILLS:

- Alertness 50%
- Appraise 40%
- Folklore 40%
- Forage/Hunt 50%
- Insight 50%
- Make Fire 40%
- Persuade 60%
- Scavenge 40%
- Stealth 60%
- Unarmed Combat 60%

Choose any 3 of these that you don't already have:

- Art (Type) 40%
- Athletics 70%
- Beguile 60%
- Carouse 40%
- Disguise/Mimic 50%
- Harangue/Taunt 50%
- Melee Weapons 70%
- Poisons 40%
- Search 60%
- Weather/Seasons 60%

STARTING RESOURCES: 2, if Protagonist is from an **agricultural** lifestyle; for **hunter/gatherers** the starting resources is the resources rating of the clan/tribe in which they live (or 0 if they have been cast out of their group)

BONDS: 5 [if Protagonist is from a **hunter/gatherer** lifestyle one of these will *automatically* be a Community Bond to the clan/tribe with strength CHA+2, the remaining bonds allocated using the standard process]

Warrior

RECOMMENDED STATS: STR, DEX

ARCHETYPAL SKILLS:

- Athletics 70%
- Carouse 50%
- Craft (Type) or Boatbuilding 50%
- Forage/Hunt 50%

- Homeland or Boating 50%
- Melee Weapons 70%
- Repair/Devise 40%
- Track 50%
- Unarmed Combat 70%

Choose any 2 of these that you don't already have:

- Animal Handling 50%
- Craft (Type) 50%
- Dodge 70%
- First Aid 50%
- Harangue/Taunt 50%
- Make Fire 60%
- Navigate 50%
- Poisons 40%
- Ranged Weapons 60%
- Scavenge 50%

STARTING RESOURCES: 3, if Protagonist is from an **agricultural** lifestyle; for **hunter/gatherers** the starting resources is the resources rating of the clan/tribe in which they live (or 0 if they have been cast out of their group)

BONDS: 4 [if Protagonist is from a **hunter/gatherer** lifestyle one of these will *automatically* be a Community Bond to the clan/tribe with strength CHA+2, the remaining bonds allocated using the standard process]

Income and Access to Resources

Unlike other *Cthulhu Eternal* eras, Protagonists may either be part of a **Hunter/Gatherer** lifestyle (everyone in the Paleolithic, some in the Mesolithic, and a few outsiders in the Neolithic), or they may be from an **Agricultural** society. In the former case, their access to resources is mostly determined by the prosperity of their clan/tribal group and their Resources score (0-20) reflects the communal “wealth” of their community, shared with all other community members. Conversely, agricultural lifestyle Protagonists have personal belongings, and their Resources score reflects their own personal prosperity.

Resources	Clan/Tribe (in a hunter/gatherer)	Personal wealth (agricultural)
0	Community is starving. Weak and old individuals routinely die of starvation. Even healthy individuals are at temporary -2 CON for tests.	Individual own no items of value or function. Penury. Near starvation.
1-4	Community is struggling to survive, having barely enough food and resources to keep everyone alive. Everyone is temporarily at -1 CON for tests.	Individual owns only basic and valueless items; barely enough to eke out a basic life. Always hungry.
5-8	Community is not as well fed as anyone would prefer, but nobody is starving. Equipment is serviceable if old and worn-out.	Individual owns a sparse personal collection of valuable or useful items, some in terrible condition. Sometimes hungry.
9-12	Community is at a comfortable level of food and resources.	Individual owns a modest personal cache of valuable, useful items. Usually has basic food.
13-16	Community is mildly prosperous, having access to good food with little worry of it running out.	Individual owns a fair personal stock of simple items. Occasional access to superior food.
17-18	Community is well resourced with everyone having their pick of food and items without anyone missing out.	Individual owns an impressive personal collection of useful gear; considered wealthy / well-resourced. Regular access to superior food

19	Community is very well resourced with its supplies of food and equipment being the envy of most similar groups nearby.	Individual is the envy of most people; personally owns numerous sought-after items of impressive function. Access to the best food and beverages.
20+	Community has benefited from a windfall of food or resources which has made life exceptionally easy and comfortable for everyone.	Individual has access to unparalleled quantities of valuable/useful items. A stockpile of personal wealth. Choice of available food, in any quantity.

Skills

Alertness

Base Rating: 20%

Alertness detects danger. Use it to hear a safety being weapon being readied, to understand the mumbling on the other side of a wall, to spot a concealed item hidden under a jacket, or to catch someone who is trying to escape notice using Stealth.

Animal Handling

Base Rating: 10%

Animals are an important part of daily life in the Stone Age, whether the earliest domesticated canines, or later with the advent of animal husbandry. Everyone has a basic understanding of caring for and trying to control animals. Animal handling can be used to calm frightened sheep, or perhaps to train a dog to hunt or guard.

Animal handling can't be used by a rider to control a mount. That's the **Ride** skill.

Appraise

Base Rating: 10%

The ability to quickly determine the true (intrinsic) value of an item. This is an important skill in ensuring that bartering exchange deals are favorable to you. It is also helpful in knowing what items or resources others might be willing to trade to obtain.

Art (Type)

Base Rating: 0%

Expertise at creating or performing a work that sways emotions and opinions. It also encompasses knowledge of techniques and trends in your field, and the ability tell a particular creator's real work from a fake. Anyone can draw a rough sketch; the Art skill reflects knowledge, practice, and talent. Each type of Art is a separate skill: Carving, Dance, Singing, Painting, Sculpture, etc.

Athletics

Base Rating: 30%

Your Protagonist trains to get the most out of his or her strength and agility. Strength and Dexterity cover raw physical power and manual dexterity; the Athletics skill represents long practice doing things like running, jumping, climbing, and throwing.

Use Athletics to:

- Outrun someone (see **OPPOSED TESTS** in the SRD).
- Jump an intimidating gap.
- Climb in a crisis.
- Land safely in a fall of up to three yards.

- Hit a target with a thrown rock or put a thrown trap exactly on target.
- Catch something without warning, such as intercepting a thrown rock or trap.

Augury

Base Rating: 0%

This skill measures knowledge of one or more of the known methods of fortune-telling used to predict the future, whether it be through watching the flight patterns of birds, reading entrails, or watching the movements of the planets amongst the stars. Usually, these techniques require multiple observation over several days before yielding some prediction – and it is often relatively vague. It is the Game Moderator’s decision as to whether the prediction is accurate or not, but in either case many (superstitious) people around the Protagonist will firmly believe that the foretold future will come to pass. They might even generously interpret the real events in a way that makes the prediction at least partially correct. For accurate and specific visions of the future, some form of ritual magic must be involved (which is well beyond the remit of this skill).

Beguile

Base Rating: 20%

In the Stone Age, oftentimes the best way to convince someone to do what you want them to do, is by appealing to their sense of power or self-importance. This delicate art combines guile, cunning, “buttering-up”, or other such subtle techniques to curry favor and obtain leverage.

Beguiling is not about open threats, teasing, or aggressive bluster – that is covered by the **Harangue/Taunt** skill. Nor is it about using cold logic to convince them (that’s **Persuade**). Rather, this skill is about using wile and cunning, coupled with a detailed understanding of the authority and power wielded by the person, to gain advantage.

If the target of the skill starts from an antagonistic viewpoint, some form of **OPPOSED TEST** will probably be needed to overcome their negative impression.

Boatbuilding

Base Rating: 10%

The knowledge required to design a waterborne vessel that will stay afloat in the prevailing conditions it is designed for. While most of the work to actually build a boat will fall under **Craft** skill specializations, Boatbuilding is required to supply the direction of this effort to ensure the end result actually works as intended.

This skill also encompasses a general understanding of the boatbuilding techniques employed by different societies and cultures, and may prove helpful in identifying the origins of a vessel.

Boating

Base Rating: 0%

Operating and navigating waterborne vehicles. Use it to keep a boat safe in a crisis, such as through a storm or in a dangerous pursuit.

Carouse

Base Rating: 0%

People have a variety of ways of reveling and relaxing when the work-day is through. This skill combines a knowledge of such social distractions and indulgences, and a practiced skill in partaking – and perhaps excelling – in their practice.

Use it to know the particular forms of entertainments that certain classes of society are likely to crave, and the people and places who are able to satisfy them – whether legally or otherwise.

When participating in a leisure activity, this skill can be called upon when endurance or skillful practice of the revelry would achieve an advantage. One such use might be retaining one's faculties even when imbibing excessive intoxicating drinks. Another might be winning at games of chance commonly used for wagering (in this case, the skill is likely to be part of an **OPPOSED TEST** against other players' **Carouse**, with sly attempts at cheating covered by the **Stealth** skill).

Craft (Type)

Base Rating: 0%

Making and repairing sophisticated tools and structures. A job that most people could figure out does not require the Craft skill, only an INT or DEX test. Use Craft for specialized work that needs training: Craft (Woodworking) to get carve a water-tight hull — or to sabotage one beyond repair; Craft (Textiles) to weave threads into fabric, and so on.

The Game Moderator decides whether a task requires Craft. Each Craft type is a separate skill: Weapon-making, Woodworking, Farmer, Rat-Catcher, etc.

Disguise/Mimic

Base Rating: 10%

Alter your Protagonist's appearance, voice, posture, body language, and mannerisms to avoid recognition without drawing attention, or to move in a way that impersonates the motions and sounds created by an animal. The latter is an important skill for stalking game; successful use can add a +20% to any **Forage/Hunt** check (+40% on a critical result), but woe betide anyone who attempts such a move close to deadly predators and fumbles the test.

Dodge

Base Rating: 30%

Evading danger through instinct and reflexes. Use Dodge to avoid an attack. Against ranged weapons and explosions, Dodge is only useful to get to cover (see **DODGING RANGED ATTACKS** in the SRD).

First Aid

Base Rating: 10%

The initial treatment and stabilization of injuries. Use it to help a character recover lost Hit Points. By comparison, **Healing** corrects a severe wound and helps ensures long-term treatment and recovery. (See **HEALING** in the SRD)

Folklore

Base Rating: 10%

Folklore is the knowledge of the customs and lore of the common people of region. It is used to deduce the proper way to enter a cave, whether to walk around the field widdershins prior to planting winter wheat, or in what order to propitiate the ancestors. It's also useful when trying to understand the myths and legends of region, such as what creature is said to live in the lake or why the eastern face of the mountain has no trees.

Forage/Hunt

Base Rating: 10%

Forage/Hunt is used to find edible food in the wilderness. The appropriate tools are required, such a club, spear, or other weapon to hunt animals. It also covers dressing the prey and preparing it for storage.

A successful roll provides enough food for a group of four to eat for a week.

Foreign Tongue (Type)

Base Rating: 0%

Ability to communicate using the verbal systems employed by another culture or group, whether languages or simple patterns of speech. Each foreign tongue is a distinct skill. Having 20% allows halting conversations; at 50% your

Protagonist speaks like a native. The greater the skill, the greater the complexity of the information your Protagonist comprehends and the less time it takes. You don't need to roll a Foreign Tongue skill unless the Game Moderator says the situation is exceptionally difficult.

Being able to speak a foreign tongue doesn't mean you can read or write text in that language (rare skills which few learn in this era). Attempts to do that are determined by the **Inscriptions** skill. The Game Moderator might require separate rolls against both skills or a single roll applied across both tests, depending on the situation.

Harangue/Taunt

Base Rating: 10%

The art of either browbeating someone into agreeing with your point of view, or of enraging them to the point where they will lose control and act in an undisciplined way that is advantageous to you.

This technique is not a subtle attempt to convince someone through a well-reasoned argument (that's **Persuade**). Nor is it a tempt to appeal to their sense of power and importance (that's **Beguile**). Instead, Harangue/Taunt is all about bluster, shouting, and threats. But sometimes these can be more successful than other techniques, although the individuals on the receiving end are unlikely to enjoy the interaction quite so much.

Taunting is a related discipline, namely an attempt to insult or belittle verbal opponents to the point where they lose their temper and say or do something rash (which they will usually later regret). In some cultures, this is a well-established way of winning an argument or establishing superiority in the minds of the community.

Healing

Base Rating: 0%

Knowledge of curative preparations, which in this era are a combination of herbal and traditional concoctions for ingestion, and poultices which could be applied to wounds. Use this skill to identify a common healing preparation, know what preparation is likely to improve a particular complaint, and safely administer a preparation.

This skill is primarily concerned with the long-term healing of injuries, diseases, or poisonings. For quick stabilization of injuries in the field, the **First Aid** skill is more useful.

Identifying a healing preparation or medicinal herb requires at least 20% skill; finding places where such ingredients may grow naturally will likely require use of the **Herb Lore** skill. Preparing a particularly powerful treatment safely, such as one with psychoactive effects, requires at least 40% skill or a successful roll. Misusing Healing is a quick way to kill a patient (see **POISON AND DISEASE** in the SRD).

Herb Lore

Base Rating: 20%

Herb Lore is an understanding of herbs, the proper method to collect them, where to find them, when to find them, and what can be done with them.

This skill doesn't include the processes required to turn herbs into poultices or salves (that's part of the **Healing** skill), nor does it instruct someone in creating Poisons from herbs (that's the **Poisons** skill).

Homeland

Base Rating: 0%

Homeland represents a protagonist's general knowledge about their homeland. Who's in charge, basic geography, known power struggles, which chieftain runs a certain community, etc.

History, Folklore, and other more specific skills should be used to gain in-depth knowledge.

Inscriptions

Base Rating: 0%

Written forms of language (pictograms etc.) are rarely employed, and few people are trained in creating or interpreting such inscriptions. Such markings are usually only used to leave permanent accounts of the deeds of the high and mighty. If you want your Protagonist to be able to interpret or create written inscriptions, he or she will need to have at least a basic rating in this skill. As a shorthand, anyone with an Inscriptions skill below 10 is unable to make any sense of written symbols; a skill rating between 11 and 40 represents a limited degree of understanding; a rating above 40 denotes a full understanding of systems of writing.

The skill does not need to be purchased separately for each of the languages known; it is assumed that the basics of reading and writing common writing systems does not need to be re-learned. Note that in many cases where an inscription written in a foreign language needs to be comprehended, this will likely involve skill tests of BOTH Inscriptions and the requisite **Foreign Tongue** skill. It is the GM's discretion as to whether tests should involve a single die roll compared to both skills, or separate rolls against each.

Insight

Base Rating: 10%

Insight obtains information about a person — especially information the subject would rather conceal — through observation, conversation, or examining patterns of behavior and relationships. Use Insight to recognize signs of dishonesty from verbal cues and body language, gauge attitude and intentions, cultivate sources of information about a subject, determine what it would take to get a subject to cooperate, or recognize clues of what a subject wants to conceal.

Insight can notice signs of mental illness but **Reassure** would be needed to assist with a specific malady. A subject who deliberately tries to deceive your Protagonist can attempt an opposed test comparing their **Persuade** against your Protagonist's Insight (see **OPPOSED TESTS** in the SRD).

Make Fire

Base Rating: 0%

Fire is essential to life in the Stone Age — it is how people stave off the cold winters, and how they cook food to ensure it is safe to eat. Everyone learns the basics of how to make fire via whichever methods are known to the local community (it could be via striking flint on stone, or by rapidly rotating a wooden rod in a palette loaded with dry leaves). When conditions are amenable and time is plentiful, no skill test is required to start a small fire. However, if there is a strong breeze, or it is raining, or if the fire needs to be started quickly (say, before a beast descends on the settlement) the GM will likely ask for a test.

Melee Weapons

Base Rating: 30%

Lethal use of melee weapons in combat. Use it to hurt or kill an opponent with a knife, axe, club, or other hand-held weapon.

Mysticism (Type)

Base Rating: 10%

The study of the supernatural as understood by human traditions, including things like magic, initiation into mystery cults, and secret societies. Use Mysticism to examine and deduce the intent of a ritual, or to identify occult traditions, groups, scrolls, tools, symbols, or legends. Mysticism can never tell a Protagonist what's genuinely unnatural and what's just superstition or mythology. That's the province of the Unnatural skill.

Mysticism is the more religious counterpart to **Folklore**. Successful Folklore and Mysticism rolls could provide the same information, viewed through different filters.

Navigate

Base Rating: 10%

Finding your way quickly from memory, directions, orienteering, or the stars.

Oral Tradition

Base Rating: 10%

In this era, most of the lore and wisdom about the world and events that have happened in the past are transmitted by oral accounts memorized and repeated down the generations. To us today this seems like an unreliable and imprecise way to record important information, but in early historical times it was the normal method – and wise individuals were able to train their memories to hold vast amounts of detail and recall it at a moment's notice (certainly much more than we can today).

This skill reflects the breadth and depth of the knowledge that your Protagonist has received in their life to date, and buried away inside their 'memory palace' for later retrieval. It can be used as a kind of general research skill, or a measure of the Protagonist's general knowledge.

Oral Tradition covers routine and well-established general knowledge about how the world really works, local taboos, and what happened in times still remembered. More specialized understanding of common spiritual beliefs is the domain of the **Spirit World** skill, esoteric lore is the province of the **Mysticism** skill, and fantastic tales about mythical creatures is covered by **Folklore**. Similarly, knowledge about the geography and politics of one's own people is covered by **Homeland**, and the equivalent details about a foreign group is captured by the **Other Tribe** skill. Knowledge about the patterns of the seasons and weather is covered by the **Weather/Seasons** skill instead.

Other Tribe (Type)

Base Rating: 0%

This skill represents a deep understanding of the people, places, and common practices that are unique to a group of people that live outside the Protagonist's normal community. Use it to recall details of the local climate, local peoples, history, and local government arrangement. It can also cover quirky beliefs or discoveries that have come to be common knowledge among members of the group.

Persuade

Base Rating: 20%

Changing another's deeply held decision or desire. Use Persuade to get your Protagonist's way when the subject is so stubborn, what your Protagonist wants is so valuable, or the deception is so flagrant that Charisma isn't enough.

With Persuade, your Protagonist might convince a witness that what she saw was innocuous and not unnatural, talk a community leader into helping you cover up an outbreak to avoid a mass panic, or draw useful information out of an unwilling subject. This skill also allows your Protagonist to resist persuasion and interrogation in opposed Persuade rolls (see **OPPOSED TESTS** in the SRD).

Poisons

Base Rating: 0%

The use of toxic preparations is common practice in the Stone Age world whether it be to silence a political rival, commit a murder, or rid a woman of an unwanted pregnancy. In most cases the use of poisons is appealing because it is much harder to trace, and may even appear to be the results of natural causes. Not all poisonings are intended to kill.

This skill includes the knowledge to prepare poisons from commonly available ingredients, the ability to detect the tell-tale signs that something bears the taint of a known poison, and the knowledge of the distinctive signs that poisons leave on their victims (often on their corpses).

All ingredients for Stone Age poisons are plants which grow naturally. This skill doesn't help with knowing where to find such plants in the wild (that would be **Forage/Hunt**) or whether other types of similar plants could be substituted if they are unavailable (that would be **Herb Lore**).

Ranged Weapons

Base Rating: 20%

The ability to accurately hit targets with ranged weapons such as Bows, Blow-guns and Slings.

This skill isn't used for thrown weapons like Spears – those make use of the **Athletics** skill instead.

Reassure

Base Rating: 10%

Use this skill to understand the mental illness afflicting a person, help an afflicted person along the journey back to sanity, or talk someone down when the mental illness threatens to take hold.

You can also use this skill to assist in social interactions with someone, to calm them from an agitated state in order to extract information from them.

You cannot use Reassure on yourself.

Using Reassure to aid someone who suffered exposure to Unnatural forces might cost the reassuring Survivor SAN; see **THREATS TO SAN** in the SRD.

Repair/Devise

Base Rating: 0%

With many settlements isolated by a day or more journey from each other, self-reliance is key. The ability to repair broken equipment or create impromptu fixes for unexpected breakages is vital.

Repair/Devise is not a craft skilled. It's designed to make some work just long enough to get the job done (hopefully). Many other *Cthulhu Eternal* settings use Craft (Jury-Rig). Repair/Devise takes the place of that in this setting.

Ride

Base Rating: 10%

Handling, training, and riding an animal—horses, donkeys, camels, whatever. Use it to keep safe on an animal in a crisis and to keep riding animals safe, calm, and healthy.

Scavenge

Base Rating: 10%

The world is full of useful items, although most people don't know where to go looking for the good stuff. Use this skill to find and salvage helpful pieces of equipment or locate valuable resources like food and water. Anyone can find items in places where they are likely to be found (e.g., food in a larder); use this skill to find things in places where nobody else would think to look.

Depending on the game setting and the scarcity of the item being sought, the difficulty of Scavenge tests and the quality of the items unearthed by successful rolls may vary. See **SCROUNGING** in the SRD.

Note that efforts to rummage for information rather than items is handled by social or knowledge skills instead.

Search

Base Rating: 20%

Finding things that are concealed or obscured from plain sight. Searching an abandoned dwelling may not require the Search skill, only time and effort, or a sufficiently high INT. Use Search to find an object that was hidden with the Stealth skill or is otherwise so well hidden or disguised that it needs an expert. The Game Moderator may roll the Search attempt, so you don't know whether your Protagonist succeeded or failed.

Spirit World

Base Rating: 10%

Peoples in the Stone Age world know that many of the major processes and events of the natural world are, in fact, governed by a host of powerful spirits beings. Some may call them 'gods', others might see spirits as beings intimately tied to the very land itself. Others might consider the spirits of long-dead ancestors to be important players in the world's events. All sensible people understand that it is important to offer devotion or material sacrifice to one or more of these spirit beings, in order to maintain their favor.

This skill encompasses knowledge of the spirit beings that are commonly venerated by your Protagonist's community. Its coverage is limited to mainstream beliefs – esoteric or hidden knowledge is more in the realms of the **Mysticism** skill, and curious tales about beings who are not recognized by the local worship are covered by the **Folklore** skill. The interpretations of omens or portents is **Augury**.

Stealth

Base Rating: 10%

Concealing your presence or activities. Use it to hide a weapon, camouflage a position, conceal a mystical carving, pick a pocket, move silently, follow without being seen, or blend into a crowd. A Protagonist attempting Stealth can be detected only by an opposing Alertness or Search skill (see **OPPOSED TESTS** in the SRD).

Swim

Base Rating: 20%

Most Protagonists can swim for leisure. Use the Swim skill in a dangerous crisis: going a long distance in choppy water, keeping a friend from drowning, or getting to a boat before the tentacled thing below grabs you.

Track

Base Rating: 10%

Use this to locate the tracks of a specific creature or person and follow them. A test must be made to locate the trail and then again once every ten minutes they are being followed. Penalties or bonuses may apply depending on how long it was since the tracks were made, what the ground is like, what the weather conditions have been since the tracks were made, etc.

Unarmed Combat

Base Rating: 40%

Self-defense. A fight between untrained combatants often involves more shoving and shouting than real violence. Use Unarmed Combat to hurt or kill an opponent with your Protagonist's bare hands (or feet, elbows, teeth, or head).

Unnatural

Base Rating: 0%

Knowledge of the fundamental, mind-shattering secrets of the universe. The things that slithered in the dark corners of the world and the cosmos beyond. Use it to remember, recognize, or research facts about the things humans consider

unnatural. This goes far beyond the occult, because the Unnatural skill represents things that are real. Use it to sift through the darkest parts of myth and folklore and recognize which of it is true.

Weather/Seasons

Base Rating: 20%

Knowledge of the patterns of the seasons and the best time to plant crops and reap, to make best use of the sun and rain. The skill also covers the day-to-day prediction of the weather, based on a combination of observation, established folk wisdom, and intuition.

Bonds

For Protagonists with a hunter/gatherer lifestyle, the bond to their local clan/tribe is an especially important Community Bond and its rating directly determines their place in the society and, to an extent, their access to resources. Losing such a bond means banishment as an outcast, which is potentially life-threatening.

Combat

The basic mechanics of combat do not vary much between different localizations of Cthulhu Eternal, but each has its own tables of weapons and armor as well as elaborations which cover unique forms of conflict or weapons technology.

Attack Skills

For games in Stone Age settings, the following skills are used for combat attacks:

- Use **Ranged Weapons** for aimed weapons (e.g., bow or sling);
- Use **Athletics** for a thrown weapon;
- Use **Melee Weapons** for a hand-to-hand weapon;
- Use **Unarmed Combat** for a punch or kick.

Weapons for Stone Age settings

Table of Example Weapons

The tables below summarize some representative weapons and vehicles that characters might have access to. Note that while the concept of LETHAL DAMAGE still exists, it is primarily applied to large-scale natural (or supernatural) events like lightning strikes, avalanches, or devastating attacks from Mythos entities.

Thrown weapons use **Athletics** as a combat skill.

>> Melee Weapons	
Sample Weapons	Damage
Bare hands and feet	1D4-1*
Stone knife	1D4*
Club	1D4 +1*
Light axe or short spear	1D6+1*
Heavy stone axe, other crushing weapons	1D8-1*
Long spear	1D8*

*Damage bonus is added for this weapon

>> Ranged Weapons			
Sample Weapons	Skill	Damage	Base Range
Sling	Ranged Weapons	1D4	30 yards
Short Bow and arrow **	Ranged Weapons	1D4+1	150 yards
Thrown Rock	Athletics	1D4-1*	STR×5 feet
Thrown Knife	Athletics	1D4*	STR×5 feet
Thrown Axe or Boomerang	Athletics	1D6*	STR×5 feet
Thrown Spear, Short or Javelin	Athletics	1D6+1*	STR×5 yards
Thrown Spear, Long	Athletics	1D8+1*	STR×4 yards

*Damage bonus is added for this weapon

** The first use of the bow and arrow dates to approximately 60,000-72,000 years ago in Africa and 48,000-52,000 years ago in Europe and Asia.

Armor for Stone Age settings

Armor	Armor Rating
Heavy cloth, winter clothes, furs	1
Hardened leather	2
Wooden wall, palisade, or thick door	5
Thick stone/brick wall or moderate rock	10
Reinforced stone/brick wall or thick rock	15

Shield Type*	# Free Parries
Improvised	1
Small	2

* The earliest shields date to the late Neolithic Age

Healing in Stone Age settings

A healer can attempt a Healing or Herb Lore test once per week: Healing for critical care of severe wounds; Herb Lore for poison, disease, and ongoing healing. If treatment succeeds, the patient recovers 1D4 HP. This is doubled with a critical, while a fumble inflicts 1D4 HP damage. At the Game Moderator's discretion, having worn-out tools or poor quality medicinal preparations/ingredients may incur a penalty.

Poisons and Diseases

The rules governing the damage inflicted by poisons and diseases don't vary between localizations, but the specific list of available toxins and infections is guided by the technology and scientific knowledge prevalent in the setting. The table below gives some examples to augment the basic list of common, naturally-occurring poisons.

>> Manufactured & Natural Poisons					
Poison	Entry Route	Speed	Lethality	Symptoms	Antidote?
Belladonna	Ingestion	30+1D20 minutes	8%	Dilated pupils, low heartrate & pulse, hallucinations	No
Cyanide / Laurel	Inhalation or Ingestion	1D6 turns	20%	Asphyxiation	No, but some treatments
Hemlock	Ingestion	30+1D20 minutes	6%	Convulsions, muscle pain	No
Monkshood/Wolfsbane	Ingestion	30+1D20 minutes	7%	Numbness, nausea, slow heartrate & pulse	No

>> Sample Diseases						
Disease	Route	Speed	CON Test Penalty	Damage	Symptoms	Cure
Ague (Malaria)	Insect bite	3D6+10 days	None	1D6	Fever & chills	No
Black Plague	Flea bite (bubonic plague), inhalation (pneumonic plague)	1D6 days	None	1D6	Fever, chills, lymph node swelling, coughing (if pneumonic), shock	No
Bloody Flux / Parasitic Worms / Snail Fever	Bad hygiene, bad water	1D6 weeks	None	1D3	Diarrhea and bleeding	No
Consumption	Inhaling cough droplets	1D6 days	None	1D4	Persistent cough, night sweats	No
Dropsy	Bacteria, exposure by contact	3+1D6 months	None	1D3	Skin lesions, weakness, blindness	No
The Fever	Insect bite	3D6+10 days	None	1D6	Fever & chills	No

The Pox	Exposure to infected person	2D6 days	−40	1D6	Fever, vomiting, ulcers, rashes, scabs	No
Spotted Fever	Fleas, lice, or mites	1D6+6 days	None	1D4	Headache, fever, chills	No
Yellow Eyes	Virus, parasite, alcoholism	2D4 weeks	None	1D3	Yellow skin, loss of appetite	No

>> Damage from Torture

If a Protagonist is beaten, whipped, or subject to another type of physical torture, he or she is required to make a **CON×3** test. The damage accrued from the experience depends on the level of success or failure of this roll:

- **Critical Success:** 1D10 HP damage for the whole session, no matter how brutal.
- **Success by 20 or more:** 1D3 damage for every 50 strikes (or equivalent).
- **Regular Success:** Lethality 3% for every 50 strikes (i.e., 3% for 50 strikes, 6% for 100 strikes, and so on).
- **Failure:** Lethality 2% for every 20 strikes.
- **Fumble:** 1D20+5 HP damage for the torture with any torture over 50 strikes results in immediate death.

Torture also takes a toll on the mental health of both torturer and victim. The torturer must make violence-related SAN tests until they've become inured to torturing others.

In some cases, torture is a form of corporal punishment, meant to do nothing other than confer pain on the victim. Other times, torture is a means to extract information. While the victim may want to stay silent, the pain of torture (or even the promise of torture) can convince the victim to divulge what they know.

When the victim wants to resist blabbering everything they know, they must attempt a **Willpower Points × 3** test. On a success, the victim can say, or not say, whatever they want. For every turn of torture that the victim survives, they lose 1D4 WP in addition to any HP lost. The **WP×3** test must be attempted after any turn of torture.

If the WP roll is a fumble, the victim can't help but tell the entire truth. A regular failure means that the victim must reveal one fact or detail, but they can choose what that is. A torturer who succeeds on an **Insight** test can tell when the truth is being told, and can choose to continue the torture even after the victim talks.

Additional Combat Rules for Stone Age settings

There's a limited amount of variety in weaponry available during this era. Their usefulness in adventures may be limited, of course, depending on who or what the Protagonists face.

The primary game statistics relating to different types of weapons may be found on the Example Weapons Table on page 18. The availability of any class of weapon will be dictated by the scarcity of weapon resources in the particular game setting (see preceding section). There are a wide variety of weapon variations throughout the Stone Age depending on culture and purpose.

What follows are some spot rules for Protagonists who have access to common Stone Age weapons.

Concealing Weapons

Knives and daggers can be concealed under ordinary clothing. Someone deliberately looking for a concealed weapon can attempt an **Alertness** test to spot it. A larger spear or club means a +20% Alertness bonus. There is no way to conceal a large melee weapon.

Hand-to-Hand Weapons

Unarmed attacks, like punching, kicking, and strangling, use the **Unarmed** Combat skill. All melee weapons use the **Melee Weapons** skill.

Ranged Weapons

Ranged weapons that are aimed (e.g., bow, and slings) use the **Ranged Weapons** skill. All require some kind of ammunition (arrows, bolts) and are useless if the supply is exhausted. Primitive weapons that are thrown (e.g., spears) use **Athletics** skill.

Mounted Combat

Ancient people used a variety of animals; typically, camels, elephants, or horses, as mounts. The earliest recorded instances of elephant and horse calvary date to around 1000 BCE during the Neolithic Era, but use of horses for mounted infantry may have occurred sooner.

If a combatant on a mount attacks an enemy who is on foot, the height advantage of the attacker affords an advantage. All such attacks are made at +20%. Similarly, attempts made by mounted combatants to dodge or fight back against attackers on foot receive a bonus of +20%. These bonuses only apply if there is a significant height advantage (and don't apply when a rider is attacking something much larger than human-sized).

Note that whenever fighting from a mount, a combatant's effective combat skill is the lesser of their **Ride** skill and their normal relevant combat skill.

Shields and Parrying

Combat in Stone Age settings is frequently up-close-and-personal, with opponents going toe-to-toe swinging, stabbing, striking and blocking. As such, the use of defensive measures such as parrying with weapons and blocking attacks with shields is common. Detailed but streamlined rules for handling extended melee fights is built into the basic rules for combat – see **DEFENSE ROLLS** in the SRD. Note that lengthy bouts of hand-to-hand combat can be particularly taxing, and combatants may become Exhausted and/or end the fight with severely depleted Willpower Points; this may affect their later actions.

Weapon Materials

Stone Age weapons are made from wood, bone, stone, and other natural materials. Items such as arrowheads, spear tips, knives, and axes are fragile and require a **Luck** test after use to see if the condition of the weapon has degraded to Junk (See **PRE-LOVED ITEMS AND SPOILED GOODS** in the SRD).

Equipment and Resources

All localizations of Cthulhu Eternal use similar mechanics for assessing the success of Protagonists' efforts to scrounge for scarce supplies or items, or attempt to solve problems by combining items with jury-rigging. The primary mechanical differences lie in the specific skills used.

For Protagonists in Stone Age games:

- Attempts to **scrounge equipment/supplies** from likely locations in the environment – tests against the **Scavenge** skill.
- Attempts to **jury-rig** a contraption – tests against **the Repair/Devise skill**.

Vehicles

The table below provides some examples of the types of vehicles common to the Stone Age.

>>A Note About Stone Age Vehicles				
Vehicles will be available in most Neolithic Era games, but only very simple vehicles will be present in earlier times (marked with an asterisk in the table below).				
One of the earliest known vehicles was the Pesse Canoe, a dugout log dated to around 8040 BCE. The earliest examples of ships are the Khufu ship in Egypt starting approximately 2500 BCE. These vessels were approximately 40 meters long and were rowed.				
The invention of the wheel dates to roughly 3400 BCE. Carts from this period could be pulled by people or animals. Prior to this, people would use sleds or sledges for transport. The first chariots date to c. 1950 BCE and were found in burial sites in modern day Russia.				

Speed

When comparing Vehicles, there is a range of different vehicle speeds. A vehicle with a 'Fast' rating grants a +20% bonus to any **Drive** or **Boating** test to pursue or escape. A 'Slow' vehicle incurs a -20% penalty instead, while a 'Very Slow' vehicle attracts a -40% penalty. An 'Average' rating confers no modifier.

A vehicle that's notorious for poor handling or that's in bad shape might counts as 'heavily worn' or 'junk' (see above) at the GM's discretion.

Some Example Vehicles

>> Vehicles				
Vehicle Type	Description	Hit Points	Armor	Speed
Litter*	Flat platform with poles at each end; carried by 2—8 people	8—10	1	Very Slow
Travois, Horse-Drawn*	Light V- or X-shaped vehicles resembling a wheelbarrow without the wheel. Dragged across earth or sand like a sledge.	10—12	2	Slow
Travois, Man-Drawn*	Same as above but pulled by human motive force.	10—12	2	Very Slow
Cart, Man-Drawn	Two-wheeled vehicle for cargo. Drawn by one or more people	15—20	1	Very Slow
Cart, Horse-Drawn	Light vehicles intended to carry a single person, possibly with an out-rider	15—20	2	Average
Chariot	Two-wheeled vehicle for travel or combat. Drawn by one or more horses.	15—20	1	Fast
Canoe	A small watercraft intended to carry cargo or small groups of people	15—20	2	Slow
Khufu Ship	Narrow boat used for cargo or transport	20—25	1	Slow

* These very simple vehicle types might be found in any Stone Age era; the remainder will only typically be present in Neolithic eras

Sanity

Most of the game mechanics surrounding Sanity do not vary between localizations of Cthulhu Eternal, however there are some small changes created through differences in available skills.

- The main skill used by Stone Age characters attempting to cure a patient of their mental illness, is: **Reassure**.

Disorders

Although the ways in which the human mind responds to stresses and mental illness have not changed for centuries, the labels applied to mental disorders have varied from era to era. To keep the descriptions of mental disorders feeling “contemporary” to a given era, localizations define their own sets of disorders. For Stone Age games, the following set are recommended.

Afear of ...

A common affliction arising from traumatic experiences is the development of an irrational fear of something related (directly or by association) with the incident. Whenever a Protagonist is in the presence of a trigger for his or her fear, he or she must make a **SAN** test (even if the trigger is not terrifying in any way to others). Failure means an acute episode has been triggered, during which there’s little choice but to suffer the Flee or Submit response to temporary insanity (see the SRD). A nearby box provides some examples of fears (what will be termed phobias in much later eras).

>>Attributing the Causes of Mental Disorders

Ancient societies attributed mental disorders to many causes mostly tied to their superstitious world view. Some cultures believed that mentally ill people were possessed by demonic entities or afflicted by the gods. Some believed such disorders arose from astrological or cosmic origins. It was not uncommon to think that such influences arose because of some kind of moral failing or as punishment for transgressing some kind of cultural norm, cosmic law, or ethical rule laid down by a divinity.

While adopting such attributions may provide an element of verisimilitude to a game, it is important to check with players regarding their comfort with blanket rulings about the (perceived) origins of mental illness. Many players will have some personal or familial experiences relating to such topics and may find the reduction of mental illness to a “demonic possession” (or similar) to diminish them and thus be personally insulting or triggering. As with all gaming, there’s no right or wrong way and the best policy is to simply check with players beforehand.

Amnesia

This is a common disorder from encounters with the unnatural. Losing 2+ SAN in any single roll triggers an acute episode, which erases all memory of the episode until your Protagonist finds a way to bring it back.

Fearful Distrust

A delusional state of extreme suspicion, in which a fear of invisible enemies pervades one’s world-view. Losing 2+ SAN in any single roll triggers an acute episode. Unless your Protagonist finds a way to stifle his or her delusions, he or she can’t trust or rely on anyone. Every event, every disagreement or source of suspicion is a clue to a conspiracy against the Protagonist.

Great Sadness

Acute sadness (what will later be termed depression) means total despair and a crushing inability to get anything done. It sometimes takes the shape of overwhelming guilt. An acute episode is triggered by reminders of past traumas your Protagonist suffered or inflicted, which can come in the most surprising forms and moments. During an acute episode, every skill or stat test costs 1D4 WP.

Hearing Voices

From time to time your Protagonist experiences auditory hallucinations in which you hear voices which others cannot. Often these are running commentaries about your thoughts or actions, usually critical and derogatory. Any time you lose 2+ SAN in any single roll, the voices return for 6+1D6 hours. You can try to hide it from those around you, but while in the grip of one of episodes you are very distracted and will automatically fail any Alertness or Search rolls and suffer a –20% penalty to any other action requiring concentration.

Mania

Your Protagonist displays a euphoric and perhaps irritable mood that is consistently present. This may include frenzied activity for no obvious reason, uncharacteristic garrulousness, a random stream-of-consciousness flow of ideas, or difficulty sleeping. An acute episode is triggered whenever your Protagonist loses 2+ SAN in a single roll. During an acute episode all tasks which require concentration or fine control are at **one-fifth chance**.

Obsession

Your Protagonist becomes fixated on some person, place, event, act, or idea. Losing 2+ SAN in any single roll triggers an acute episode, which lasts days. In that time, any long-term action or skill use—anything taking more than a few hours—is at –20% because your Protagonist’s mind is so often wrapped around its obsession.

Plagued By Nightmares

Your Protagonist feels exhausted all the time, barely able to get out of bed in the morning. It might be that some terribly traumatic encounter has left its scars upon them, or it may be just the accumulated stresses of a lifestyle with too much mental fatigue. But being bereft of energy does not equate to being well rested – in fact, your Protagonist sleeps poorly and is always waking to anxiety-inducing memories from the past. An acute episode is triggered by tangible reminders of past traumas your Protagonist suffered or inflicted. In an acute episode, the Game Moderator chooses one effect: your Protagonist either reacts violently to threats only the Protagonist perceives, or suffers an acute bout of melancholy. (See **GREAT SADNESS** nearby for details.)

Reliant on [Intoxicant]

Your Protagonist relies on some intoxicant or other (whatever is available in the setting) to get by. However much harm the compulsion causes, your Protagonist needs the relief it offers. Losing 2+ SAN in any single roll triggers an acute episode, an overwhelming need. Feeding it usually imparts a –20% penalty to stats and skills for a few hours due to intoxication or distraction. And even in the best of times, going 24 hours without feeding the compulsion costs 1D6 WP and prevents your Protagonist from recovering any WP. Every further 24 hours costs 1D6 WP. At 2 or fewer WP, your Protagonist does irrational, self-destructive things to feed the compulsion.

Self-Absorbed

There are some whose certainty in their own pre-eminence knows no bound (today we would call them narcissists). Some people afflicted with this disorder see themselves as messiahs, or as exempt from ordinary morality. Losing 2+ SAN in any single roll triggers an acute episode, in which every hint of doubt about your Protagonist’s superiority fills him or her with indignation. That causes every use of a stat or skill to get help or make a good impression to fail.

Wander-Lust

Literature is filled with examples of protagonists suffering a bout of madness and then wandering the wilderness for years until they’re cured and make a triumphant return to society. While wandering, they typically have no contact with humans and live a life akin to the beasts.

If a Protagonist is afflicted with wander-lust, they are effectively out of the game for the duration of their wandering. Every game month the Protagonist wanders they attempt a **Luck** test. With success, the Protagonist returns to society cured of their disorder. If the Protagonist fails the Luck roll, they must wander another month, but have a flash of Insight, increasing a skill of their choice by +1D6 percentiles.

Fears

- Afeared of heights
- Afeared of open places
- Afeared of cats
- (for female Protagonists): Afeared of males
- Afeared of bees
- Afeared of spiders
- Afeared of thunder, lightning and storms
- Afeared of frogs and toads
- Afeared of the deep sea
- Afeared of plants
- Afeared of reflections
- Afeared of confined spaces
- Afeared of crowds
- Afeared of trees
- Afeared of fur
- Afeared of insects
- (for male Protagonists): Afeared of females
- Afeared of blood
- Afeared of forests
- Afeared of healers
- Afeared of being alone
- Afeared of dead things
- Afeared of snakes
- Afeared of fire
- Afeared of darkness
- Afeared of the sea
- Afeared of hair
- Afeared of foreigners
- Afeared of animals

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